

APAC BUSINESS Headlines

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Most
Advanced
Fleet
Management
Solution
Providers from
APAC

What Does
The Surge In
Technology
Mean For
**FLEET
MANAGEMENT ?**

COVER STORY

SANKAR RAGAVAN, CEO

**TRAILBLAZING THE
MODERNIZATION OF APAC'S
MARITIME INDUSTRY**

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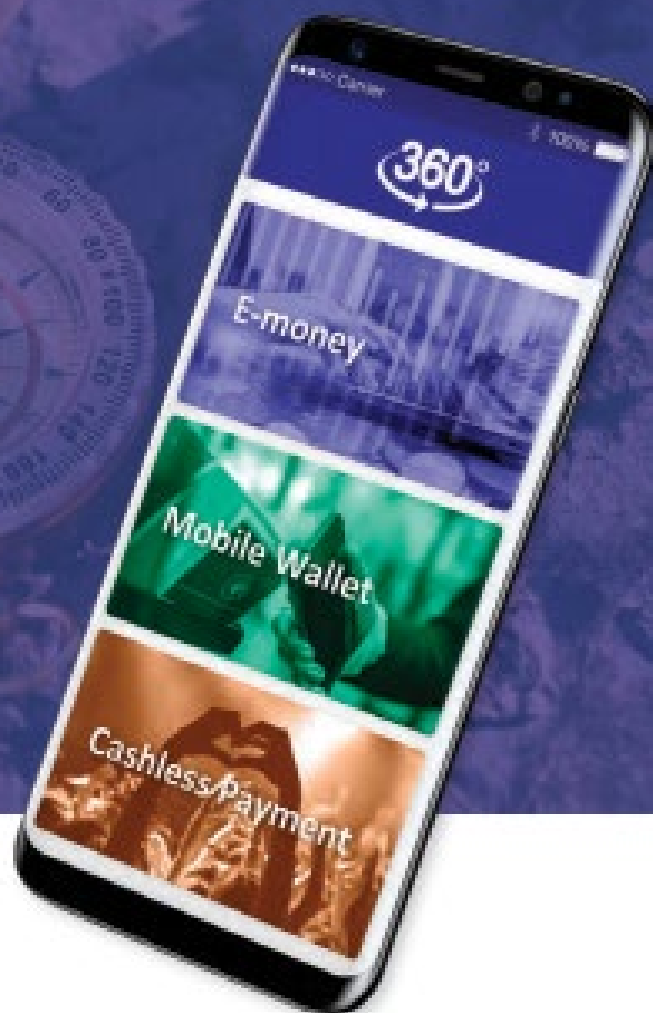
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Cellum Secure

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Cellum APAC headquartered in Singapore, with live implementations in Indonesia and Japan

COVER STORY

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SOLUTION PROVIDERS FROM APAC**



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FLEET



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Editorial

What Does The Surge In Technology Mean For Fleet Management?

Technology has always enabled human to change work process to improve safety, productivity, efficiency. Today, with the rapid pace of technology advancement, change has become drastic for many industrial fields. How is the Fleet Management field coping up with technology that is progressing at an accelerated rate?

In this issue, we look into how Fleet Management is changing because of technology and how fleet owners can use this to their advantage. Overall fleet management efficiency has improved significantly in recent years, due to the implementation of advanced AI, GPS, Sensors, and Smart Devices.

But that does not come easy. Many companies and fleet owners struggle to cope up with the change to remain a competitive service provider by delivering service that satisfy customers. Finding the right partner and technology application and the implementing them efficiently is a hard nut to crack, especially in a market that has an endless supply of new technology.

In this issue we explore the implication of new technology applications for fleet owners and how they can work with solution providers to take advantage of the development. We had a conversation with some of the Most Advanced Fleet Management Solution Providers from APAC about the ways fleet owners can adopt technology solution to improve their services. We gained insights into their innovative process, and how their solutions are making impacts to their clients.

In our cover story, we feature the incredible story of MariApps that is trailblazing the modernization of APAC's maritime industry. Along with that we feature few other top players in fleet management discussing the progress in the field and their valuable services and solutions that is making a big impact in the market.

It has been an absolute pleasure for us at APAC Business Headlines to have a conversation with the great leaders and companies who have shared valuable insights for better global business and trade. We hope that you will find it helpful and valuable as you flip through the stories of this issue.

Let us know your thoughts.



Blockchain is Shaking up Supply Chain

By Sarah, Staff Writer

“

Transparency in Blockchain helps reduce delays and disputes while preventing goods from getting stuck in the supply chain

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Supply chain has become complicated. It takes days to make a payment between a manufacturer and a supplier, or a customer and a vendor. Contractual agreements require the services of lawyers and bankers, each of which adds extra cost and delay the process. Products and parts are often hard to trace back to suppliers, making defects challenging to eliminate.

The rise in uncertainty stops supply chains from working well. Suppliers, providers, and clients must interact via central third-party entities instead of directly with each other. Apparently, simple transactions turn into lengthy multi-step procedures.

Blockchain could be the answer to many of these issues. In supply chain, it can apply to anything from self-executing supply contracts to automated cold chain management. One of the most appealing benefits of using blockchain is that it allows the data to be more interoperable.

Due to this, it becomes easier for companies to share information and data with manufacturers, suppliers, and vendors. Transparency in Blockchain helps reduce delays and disputes while preventing goods from getting stuck in the supply chain. As each product can be tracked in real-time, the chances of misplacements are rare.

Ultimately, blockchain can efficiently increase the transparency of supply chains and positively impacts everything from warehousing to delivery and payment.

Blockchain's Value in Today's Supply Chains

Any supply chain progresses by initially delivering the raw materials from a supplier to a manufacturer and eventually ends by delivering the final product to the consumer. The interconnectivity of different elements in the supply chain gradually becomes more inefficient when a business grows. Blockchain

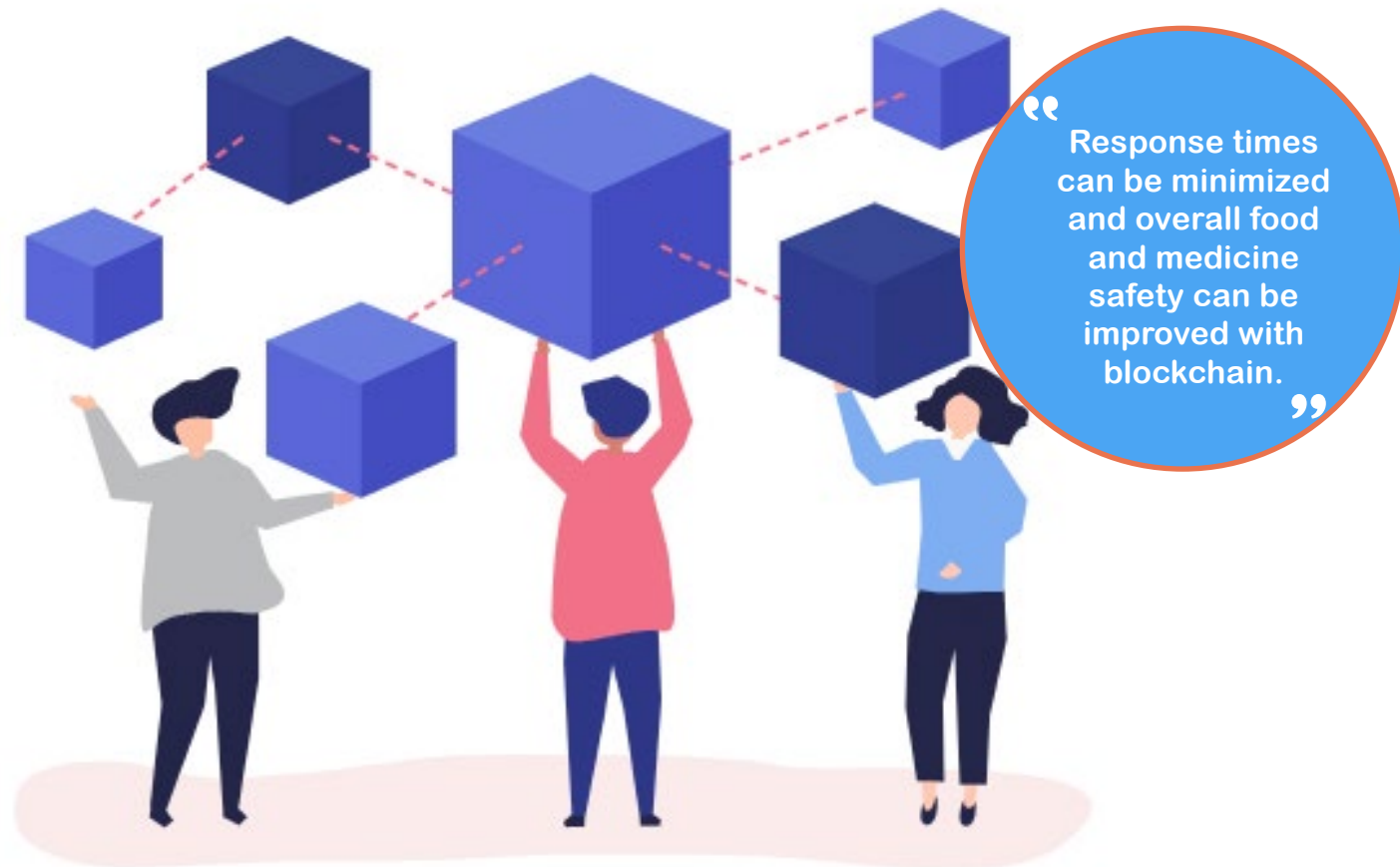
can be applied to many challenges of the Supply Chain industry such as complicated record-keeping and tracking of products.

Automotive Supplier Payments

Australian vehicle manufacturer Tomcar uses Bitcoin to pay some of its suppliers. Tomcar's supplier agreements use standard terms. It is helpful for cost savings. The firm is also careful not to hang onto Bitcoin too much. While Bitcoin is international by nature, some national governments see it as a way for companies to invest. Companies may, therefore, be subject to taxation on Bitcoin holdings.

Meat Traceability

In the food industry, it's imperative to have solid records to trace each product to its source. Companies can use blockchain to record product status at each stage of production. The records are permanent and immutable. It makes it



possible to trace each product to its source. Global retailer Walmart uses blockchain to track sales of pork in China. This system lets the company see where each piece of meat comes from, each processing and storage step in the supply chain, along with the product's sell-by-date. In the event of a product recall, it is easier for the company to see which batches are affected and who bought them.

Electric Power Micro-grids

The use of blockchain in electric power micro-grids can be an example of how entities of any size can use blockchain. Smart contracts are being used to redistribute excess power from solar panels. The Transactive Grid is an application running on blockchain to monitor and redistribute energy in neighborhood micro-grid. This program automates the buying and selling of green energy to save costs and pollution.

The introduction of blockchain in the energy industry will not only disrupt the traditional structure of the market but also increase the efficiency of

payment, energy usage, and energy storage.

Cold Chain Monitoring

Every single food pharmaceutical products can be assigned a cryptographically unique identifier at the start of the cold chain. This unique, strongly encrypted code can be entered into the shared data ledger, and the history of all products can be accessed on the blockchain archive. Sensors on sensitive products can record temperature, humidity, vibration, and other environmental conditions. This end-to-end transparency and traceability will streamline the entire process. Any issues resulting in unsafe food or medication can be detected swiftly and resolved within a matter of hours. Response times can be minimized and overall food and medicine safety can be improved.

Similarly, Blockchain can be applied in RFID-driven contract bids and execution, seafood verification, coffee supply chain, shipping industry, etc.

Blockchain has introduced its po-

tential to bring out positive changes in many industries and businesses till date including the supply chain industry. In fact, the supply chain management is one of the most obvious and useful applications of Blockchain technology, therefore, we can expect it to grow at a very fast pace in the near future. The source of the successful operation of the supply chain management system is to keep a robust, transparent and end-to-end communication.

The value of adopting blockchain technology can be taken from the fact that it has the potential to connect different ledgers and data points while maintaining data integrity among multiple participants. The properties of transparency and immutability of blockchain technology make it useful for eliminating frauds in supply chain and maintaining the integrity of the system.

Companies are bringing more rigors to purchase order payments or demand chains where 'real demand' signals can propagate the upstream supply chain faster.



MARIAPPS



TRAILBLAZING THE MODERNIZATION OF APAC'S MARITIME INDUSTRY

Driven by visionary leaders and passionate employees, MariApps is a pioneer in providing digital solutions to the marine industry. The service allows users to track vessels; reduce operational risk and maximize uptime; fetch real-time finance, performance and operational data and so much more. It is facilitating better decision-making and enabling efficient fleet management with new technology solutions, steering the industry towards a bright digital future.

The shipping industry is the principal means of international trade today, managing 90% of global trade. As it is an increasingly demanding industry, there are challenges to tackle, such as ensuring ship-shore connectivity, maintaining communication, managing voyages, synthesizing data, and upgrading legacy systems. This is where, MariApps as a forward-thinking organization, is broadening many horizons in the industry by providing world-

class, comprehensive and effective digital tools for every aspect of maritime fleet management.

Helping Maritime Businesses Embrace Emerging Technologies

Sankar Ragavan, the company's CEO, has immense experience as an IT professional, having served global organizations such as Jumeriah International, various MNC's and Bernhard Schulte Ship management where he was the Corporate IT Director.

Sankar was integral to setting up MariApps in 2014 with the vision to help the maritime industry easily adapt and embrace emerging technologies such as data analytics, artificial intelligence and robotics. The core team researched, developed and provided various software, useful ERP, data analytics tools and easier ways to share information.



“

MariApps is facilitating better-decision making and is enabling efficient fleet management with new technology solutions, steering the industry towards a digital future.

”

SANKAR RAGAVAN, CEO



Leading the Industry with State-of-the-Art Software

MariApps' exhaustive digital tools bring in key knowledge and expertise to help maritime professionals succeed in today's increasingly demanding business environment. Its flagship product **smartPAL** is the first-of-its-kind ERP system for modern maritime fleet management.

It's a fully digitized, cloud-supported and mobile compliant suite for ship managers and owners to overlook critical day-to-day activities. This is because the suite encompasses all important functions: crewing, payroll, planned maintenance, procurement, finance, HSEQ, catering, voyage, document management and insurance, on a single platform.

The suite's centralized nature makes every aspect of maritime fleet management straightforward and therefore ensures much more efficient operations. Users can better understand voyage performance and key operational data, to enable better decision-making, to improve overall efficiency and to mitigate risks. And it also allows users to easily connect and network with leading banks, travel systems, and major vendors.

Moreover, the company offers additional innovative products such as:

1. LiveFleet: A single app for ship owners to monitor vital information such as fuel optimization and to track vessels in near real time,

2. eConnect: An end-to-end eCommerce platform providing an easy and efficient way to process transactions and monitor exchange of goods,

3. TRIPplanner: Holistic travel management system bridging corporate companies and travel agent groups,

4. New Building: A module used to track the progress of construction and testing activities of ship construction,

5. Makers Portal: A data store of vendors and manufacturers of ship parts and machineries,

6. Plan Approval Module: A document flow control system to review and approve ship drawings, and more.

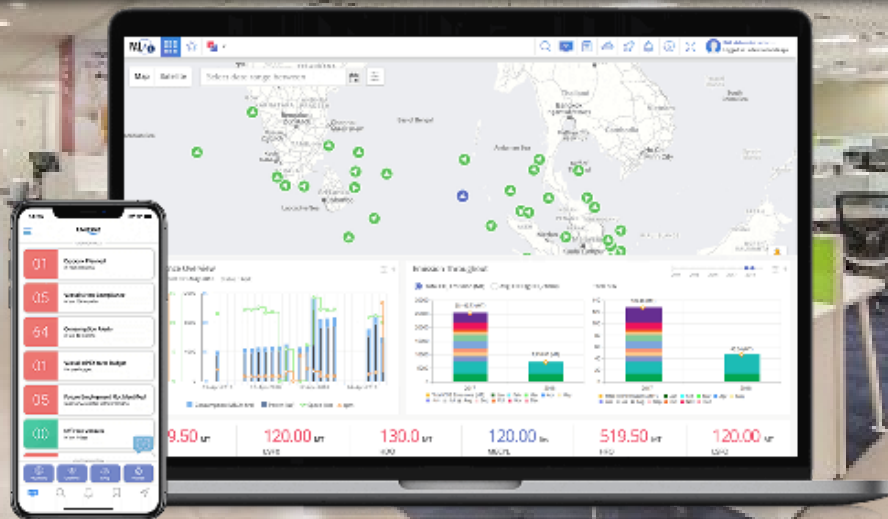
MariApps also offers mobile apps to help users stay updated and informed on the go. Some of these functions allow them to streamline crew-related processes, inspect vessels thoroughly, and manage travel plans, payments, and certificates.

An Ever-Present Guide and Partner to Customers

The company's main vision is to guide maritime organizations on the digital journey, primarily through partnerships with them. Apart from their software, MariApps is renowned as a constant guide and partner to customers, guiding them through the challenges within the industry's modernization.

"If you buy our solution we will not be a vendor walking away after selling the license to you, we will stay back to

“We will not be a vendor walking away after selling the license to you, we will stay back to overlook the complete implementation.”



overlook the complete implementation. We will come in as a partner and take over organizational change management, communication management and project management,” Sankar assures. MariApps is always available to clients, guiding them whenever needed, training them with the application which in turn will secure a profitable return on investment.

Progression Supported by Partnerships and Networking

MariApps strongly advocates partnerships and networking in business. Through partnerships, the company has been investing in newer, more dynamic technologies such as blockchain and Big Data to upgrade the quality of its services.

“We have a sizeable number of partners who are helping us grow our solutions and implement them across the globe. One of our biggest partners is Microsoft. We use Microsoft technologies everywhere, including their cloud adoption, dot net platform and DevOps platform,” Sankar says. “We also work closely with Deloitte to ensure our system audits and securities side are fully compliant, and this is done annually,” he continues.

The company has also partnered with Chicago-based data transfer company ‘Binfer’, a Bangalore-based blockchain company ‘Krypsy’ and more intending to systematically improve the standards of its service.

Supporting the Company’s Greatest Asset: Employees

“We are a dynamic, young, and passionate company, committed to the development of the best solutions for the industry”, Sankar says. “Employees are our biggest strength and our greatest assets. We have more than 450 employees across the globe. They all are loyal, committed and working hard to ensure our customers are happy. We also provide them with great working environment good pay and benefits, flexible work hours and challenging projects,” he adds further.

MariApps continually trains its employees who bring a blend of varied expertise spanning technology, shipping domain expertise and change management to the company.

Towards Newer Frontiers in Excellent Services

MariApps has a global presence, headquartered in Singapore, with offices in India, Germany, UAE, France, and Cyprus, and its software runs on over 1,000 vessels today.

“We are entering into new domains like Travel and Insurance, which has immediate interactions with shipping industry. MariApps is currently building a digital platform, combining data from smartPAL ERP and telemetry data, which will take us to the next level of digital platform services, enabling new processes in ship management,” Sankar concludes.

APAC BUSINESS Headlines

MOST ADVANCED FLEET MANAGEMENT SOLUTION PROVIDERS FROM APAC

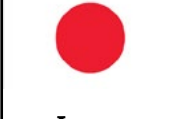
Due to technology advancement, the field of Fleet Management is also changing. It was once the case that fleet managers relied upon manual tools such as a thick specification book, green sheets, and calculators to run their fleets. Now, the field is adopting advanced AI, data analytics, GPS to do away with a lot of the manual work and to improve safety and efficiency in fleet management.

Developments such as real-time data analytics and reporting have become invaluable for modern fleet managers, providing immediate access to data that were not possible before. This data enables managers to analyze driver performance, make key improvements, and create an overall more productive fleet, all at a much faster rate. Through a secured and user-friendly web/mobile interface, the job for fleet manager is also getting much more efficient and convenience. As the transformation continues, fleet manager has to keep up to date with the latest technology and best practice in the field. This will enable utilizing and managing vehicles efficiently and safely with improved productivity.

In this issue of APAC Business Headlines, we look into the work of some of the best solution providers in the field from APAC. They are helping in tracking and managing vehicles through GPS tracking system on duty, driver performance, fuel consumption and route monitoring real-time. They are making a huge impact in the market by bringing new innovation and improving safety, efficiency and productivity. It is with great delight that we present the region's Most Advanced Fleet Management Solution Providers from APAC.

APAC BUSINESS Headlines

MOST ADVANCED FLEET MANAGEMENT SOLUTION PROVIDERS FROM APAC

 India	ASTI INFOTECH astiinfotech.com India	Mahendra Pratap CEO	Asti Infotech offers customizable business solutions through high-end GPS, RFID, Bluetooth and NFC technologies. By leveraging mobile and web applications, the company delivers user-friendly and handy products.
 Australia	Future Fleet futurefleet.com.au Australia	Richard Saad General Manager	Future Fleet are leading providers of customised GPS vehicle tracking, fleet management and cost efficiency solutions to Australian businesses across all industries.
 Japan	Ichinen Holdings ichinenhd.co.jp Japan	Masashi Kuroda President and CEO	ICHINEN GROUP is a holding company that develop and support affiliate companies while each of them manages itself independently. It has developed business in automotive leasing, chemical, parking, machine tool sales, and synthetic resin.
 Singapore	MariApps mariapps.com Singapore	Sankar Ragavan CEO	MariApps offering maritime applications for the marine industry. The company helps it clients to excel in today's competitive and demanding environment by delivering key knowledge and expertise solutions of the market.
 Taiwan	SYSTECH systech.com.tw Taiwan	Mark Fowler CEO	Systech is a market leader with proven solutions specifically in Automatic Vehicle Locating (AVL) and Geographical Information Systems (GIS).



ASTI INFOTECH:



Simplifying the Complex Fleet Management Processes for Businesses



Mahendra Pratap
CEO

“

Asti Infotech works with a purpose of exploiting the new technologies such as IoT and AI to resolve many real-time problems in Fleet Management.

”

In this fast-paced world, improving operational efficiency has become a holy grail that every enterprise wants to chase. And one of the highly efficient ways for businesses to perk up their operational efficiency is to incorporate an effective fleet management process in place. Keeping the fleet well managed can help businesses to optimize their everyday operations, reduce costs and maintain a healthy bottom line.

However, with multitudinous challenges such as multi-geographical barriers, uncertainty surrounding the vehicle's location and regulatory compliance, managing fleet becomes a complex task to handle. Riddled with a bundle of complications and uncertainties, fleet management calls for a unique solution and this is precisely what Asti Infotech, a prominent fleet management solution provider offers to its clients.

Headquartered in Bangalore, the leading firm has been working with a single-minded purpose of exploiting the new technologies such as IoT and AI to resolve many real-time problems and accelerate the growth of industries dealing with logistics, transportation, and mobile sales force.



Ms. Sonal Malhotra

“ Commitment to innovation and the encouragement of new ideas is the cornerstone of our philosophy.

”

The wide range of simple yet effective solutions offered by Asti Infotech helps users to prevent accidents and thefts, increase productivity, streamline communication, reduce time to complete tasks, improve quality, visibility, efficiency, operational stability, customer satisfaction and much more.

Delivering Simple, Robust and User-Friendly Solutions

As one of the dominant players in the fleet industry, Asti Infotech facilitates customers with a portfolio of products that range from basic GPS tracking system to driver drowsiness detection solution. While the GPS school bus tracking system (Trakom) offered by the company ensures peace of mind to parents by tracking and updating them about the location of their children during their commute, its driver drowsiness detection solution provides real-time alerts regarding all the potential symptoms of fatigue to help in ensuring the safety of the driver and passengers.

In conjunction with this, the company also provides fleet management solutions (AFM) and vehicle tracking and monitoring solution (VTMS). AFM helps companies to manage their fleet of vehicles

and assure safer commute to employees whereas the vehicle tracking and monitoring solution helps fleet managers in the transportation/logistics industry to plan and track the transportation needs of business in a more efficient way.

Besides fleet management solutions, the innovative firm delivers a broad range of services for schools and enterprises to help them in performance monitoring and overall management. The technically adept team at Asti Infotech has developed Asti School ERP Solution to help schools smoothly integrate multiple departments and manage school activities and RFID attendance management and student monitoring solution to automate attendance management systems in schools and school buses. Similarly, for businesses, the company provides imprint, salesforce performance monitoring solutions to help sales managers and professionals improve their productivity and attain the highest potential.

Creating a Difference through Innovation and Customer-Centric Approach

“Innovation is our tradition. Commitment to innovation and the encouragement of new ideas is the cornerstone of our philosophy. Our mission is



to create happy and satisfied clients who consider us partners in their growth,” asserts Mahendra Pratap, CEO of Asti Infotech.

The success of the pioneering company lies in its ability to continuously innovate but what really differentiates the firm is that its products are developed with the customers in mind. While creating a new innovative solution, the company always designs it with one purpose in mind: to make it simpler and beneficial for its clients.

“All our solutions incorporate smarter and user-friendly modules that ensure maximum business benefits to our clients. Be it the data security, assistance, support & training or scalability, we ensure to serve our customers the best. Responsibility towards our clients is one of our greatest values—we do everything to provide more with less investment of their time and money,” says Mahendra.

Backed by a group of experienced and passionate professionals who have worked very closely with various industries, the company understands the process in-depth and provides a solution that can enhance the businesses and ROI of its clients.

Fostering a Creative and Healthy Work Culture

Apart from a clear focus on creating happy and satisfied clients through innovation, Asti Infotech also heavily

focuses on nurturing a sense of belief and ownership for learning among its employees. The company always motivates and encourages its employees to bring out and express their views and skills and helps them to reach their maximum potential.

“Working at Asti is filled with challenges, opportunities, and rewards in equal measure. Employees are given the freedom to come up with their own ideas, execute them and own them,” avers Mahendra.

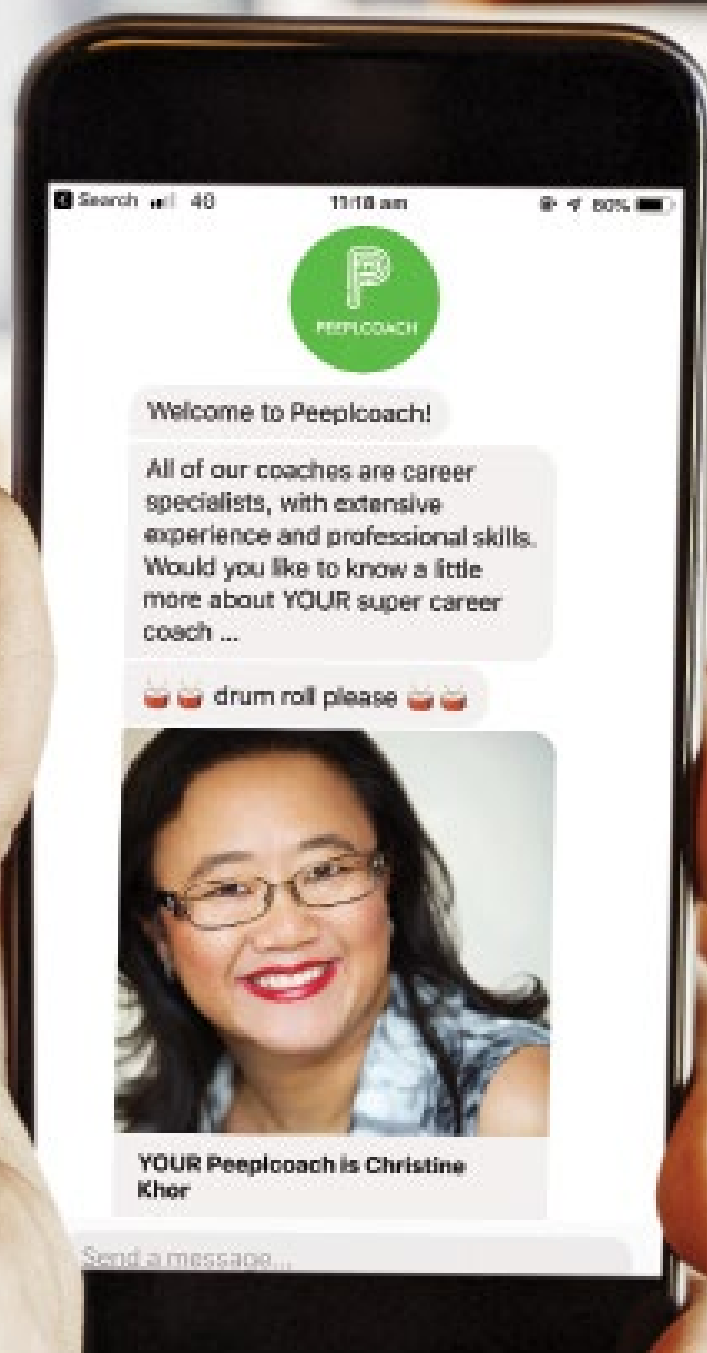
The firm also exponentially rewards the hard work and maintains a fun work environment abuzz with creativity, cutting-edge technology and team spirit.

Intend To Expand Its Product Line and Customer Reach

With its groundbreaking innovations and technology excellence, Asti Infotech has attained a unique edge in the market. But not resting on its laurels, the inventive company with its industry rich experience further intends to leverage new technologies and spread out globally in the coming years.

“Asti continues to mine new technologies to expand its product line and customer reach. With these twin objectives over the next few years, we foresee ourselves as a well-established technology-driven company in the Indian and International market,” concludes Mahendra.

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DEVELOPING STRATEGIC LEADERSHIP

WHAT'S ON YOUR TO-BE LIST TODAY AS LEADERS?

By Rebecca Livesey, Managing Director, Achieve-Lead-Succeed

“

Having a strong aligned purpose, a clear set of values and standards, and a supportive belief system means your team and the people around you know they can rely on your 'Why' and 'How', even if the 'What' is uncertain.

”



We are facing an interesting challenge in business right now. The pace of technology advancement and corresponding rate of change needed in organisations is incredible. To combat this we are all working frantically on improving business agility, optimising our business models, driving transformations, being disrupters before being disrupted. And somehow in this big old space of uncertainty we have to bring our people along for the ride.

Here's the conundrum –brains (and therefore people!) like certainty, and right now more than ever it is difficult to say what will happen with emerging technologies, which mar-

ket will be disrupted next, what a business will look like going forward and how long before it may need to change again. And as leaders we are all working hard on how to provide that certainty, how to respond to external factors, how to mitigate risks - yet more things to add to the ever growing To-Do list!

So what do we do about this? In my experience, when leaders scrap the To-Do List and work on their To-Be List, they provide certainty for their people in this ever changing world.

In other words -we can't always be certain about the 'What', but as leaders we can be certain about the 'How' and the 'Why'.

This is the crux of authentic values based leadership – are you 'Being' with certainty? Have you set up the environment for success for your team based on a strong purpose to which you are aligned? Have you a clear set of values and standards around delivering them? Does your belief system support the direction of the business?

I've found that answering these three questions brings the focus to how we are Being, rather than what we are Doing. And when there are problems in the Doing (eg. execution issues, or un-resourceful people conflicts) it's often because we don't have clear consistent answers to these questions.

“

Set higher standards for yourself than the organisation demands, and stick to them consistently.”

”



So let's consider a strong purpose to which you are aligned. Have you worked with your executive peers to develop a strong business 'Why'? Does everyone in the business understand how they contribute to this Why?

What about your 'personal why'. What gets you up out of bed every morning excited to take on the world? It may not always be the mission of the business you work for, but does it support that mission? Consider if your 'personal why' is self-serving or others-focussed. The chances are - if it is others-focussed you can find alignment, self-serving motives, however well hidden, reduce the capacity for trust in the environment, and lack of trust is an alignment killer.

Then move onto values. Values are simply what are important to us, consciously or unconsciously. A good test is to look at where you (or the business) spend time and mon-

ey. This generally indicates what we think is important!

Which is why it is also crucial to set standards of behaviour around values. We may state a value of Safety for example, but the moment a leader is witnessed walking past an unsafe act without challenging because 'they were in a hurry', a standard eroding moment has occurred and the environment suffers.

Consider your personal values and how they flow into standards in your business life. Set higher standards for yourself than the organisation demands, and stick to them consistently.

Finally a strong belief - It's interesting to check in with yourself to see if you truly believe in the direction of your business and its ability to get there. Because if you don't, your team will pick up on it. The majority of our communication is non-verbal and these tricky little beliefs will sneak

through you and create uncertainty!

Beliefs are what we hold to be true, a convenient assumption of reality! We can, if we choose, 'try on' beliefs. If we consider someone we admire who is getting results in an area of life in which we would like results, model their thinking by trying on their beliefs and see what results we get. Choose your beliefs to serve and support you. If it serves and supports you as a leader to believe in the business' direction, because it provides certainty for your team, choose that.

Having a strong aligned purpose, a clear set of values and standards, and a supportive belief system means your team and the people around you know they can rely on your 'Why' and 'How', even if the 'What' is uncertain.

So I encourage you as transformational leaders, to focus on creating certainty in Being, and start working on and ticking off your To-Be List.



Revitalizing Australia's Fleet Management Industry Using Powerful Technology



ASHAN MALASEKERA
CEO

“

Future Fleet provides advanced, customizable and comprehensive digital solutions emphasizing driver safety and enhanced vehicle tracking.

”

As millions of new vehicles are added onto our roads, waterways and airspaces each year, travelling becomes more and more dangerous. Due to the risks involved, the safety of drivers, company-owned vehicles and goods is a very high priority, especially in transport and logistics sectors. So, there is a rising demand from large organizations for effective fleet management services with a foundational emphasis on ensuring real-time safety today.

To realize such services, forward-thinking fleet management service providers are applying the latest in technology to create highly effective, powerful and lightweight digital software. These tools can effectively monitor the driving experience to detect negatives including poor vehicle condition, drivers' fatigue or incapacity to function, congested roads, accidents, harsh terrain or weather conditions and natural disasters.

Supporting the Fleet Management Industry with State-of-the-Art Solutions

One of Australia's most innovative fleet management service providers today is Future Fleet, a company providing advanced, customizable and comprehensive digital solutions emphasizing telematics, GPS technology, driver safety and vehicle tracking. The



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The company delivers unique and specialized fleet management solutions for clients, even enhancing existing products with the latest technologies.

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company emerged when the founders recognized the high value for technology-supported fleet management services for the Australian market. Once they realized how GPS technology-aided solutions can radically uplift productivity levels, improve profits, reduce operational costs, ensure drivers' safety among more benefits, they set up headquarters in Queensland, in 2003.

Today, the company is one of Australia's biggest dealers of MiX Telematics, a global leader in fleet management industry. The company provides MiX Telematics' world-class fleet management services combined with continual support to all clients, from installation, customer guidance and on-going support. Aided by the latest in technology, these services aim to realize the safest driving experiences by allowing users to expertly monitor tasks, routes, driver's fatigue level, assets, journey, communication and more. Additionally, the company offers DynaMiX, the powerful and complete fleet management software for enterprise clients with many features designed to maximize return on investment, reduce costs, mitigate risks, and improve customer experience.

Future Fleet also offers some in-house products. The company offers two products designed especially for fleet management in the cold chain industry: Future Fleet® 3G iridium 2 Way Reefer Telematics Solution and Future Fleet® Reefer GPS Tracking Solution. It also offers Future Fleet PLUS, a dynamic and comprehensive fleet management platform for every requirement in logistics as well as cold chain projects. Finally, it also offers many trailer and asset tracking solutions that are highly customizable. Customers can avail additional

optional features as well: weatherproof coating, solar powered back up power source and iridium satellite or 3G network for remote coverage.

Firmly Established for Unique, Specialized and Cost-Effective Services in the Market

As the Future Fleet team has over 30 years of experience and advanced knowledge in telecommunications, information technology and in particular, GPS technology, they are highly competent. Thanks to the core team's domain expertise and decades of experience, the company is trusted throughout the nation for professional honesty and stability.

Future Fleet is unique in the market today. The company delivers unique and specialized fleet management solutions for clients, even enhancing existing products with the latest technologies. They are renowned for highly effective, cost-efficient and customizable fleet management solutions for diverse clients in all industries. Additionally, the company is also very famous for its friendly customer support services.

Over the years, Future Fleet has grown immensely: the company is now a member of several nationally important organizations of the fleet management sector. These include the Australian Trucking Association (ATA), the Refrigerated Warehouse and Transport Association (RWTA) and the Bus Industry Confederation (BIC). Being supported by a successful track record in the market, a solid professional reputation and high capacity to deliver excellent solutions in future, the company is continually broadening the horizon for the Australian fleet management sector.

CHANGE YOUR WORKFORCE WITH TECHNOLOGY INTERSECTION AND IN-PERSON COMMUNICATION

By Steve ZoBell, Chief Product & Technology Officer, Workfront

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Automated work is a higher order of the trusted system, so be sure that process and systems are in place before automating anything

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The integration of technology into the modern workforce has drastically impacted what the typical day looks like and the variety of responsibilities expected from employees. Between responding to emails, providing status updates in project management tools, attending meetings and all the in between – many find it difficult to focus on what they were hired to do. At Workfront, we discovered enterprise workers spent only 39% of their day on primary job duties. So what makes up the other 61%? While there are of course the occasional breaks, the rest of the day is made up of what we call Shadow Work. The concept and necessity of shadow work will never go away. But as technology in the workplace is increasingly streamlined to enhance

productivity, there are ways to bring these extra tasks out of the shadows, illustrate impact and provide visibility into work that is not a value add and should be automated.

Here are four key ways to highlight the breadth and depth of the work you're doing and harness the power of technology to redefine your workday.

1. Establish a process by bringing the online, offline

Before you can use technology effectively, you must have a good process in place. Leaders can jumpstart this by bringing the online, offline with an in-person communication. As unnecessary meetings are often cited as one of the biggest time wasters, make sure there is a clear, focused

goal so everyone walks away feeling productive. Teams need to learn how to identify things that are both urgent and important – and to have that same shared focus across the group. A common issue is for teams to be misaligned on priorities and the resources available to get tasks done. By bringing this focus together in-person, teams will learn to better communicate and think through which items are both urgent and important. Once this shared understanding is developed, technology and productivity tools can be integrated to further enhance the process. Another simple measurement you can use to validate the value of your meeting is to simply multiply the number of people in the room by the length of the meeting, then truly evaluate if, for example, the 9-per-



son, 2-hour meeting is really worth devoting 18 hours of total time.

2. Get everything into a trusted system

Too much time and mental capacity is spent trying to remember things – to do lists, meetings, status updates. Rather than spend our mental energy trying to remember what the last update was on a project, teams need to aggregate everything into a central, trusted system. This shifts the administrative work online, and allows you to free up your brain power to solve bigger problems more creatively. If you are a team member and your technology resources are seriously lacking, advocate for yourself and your team. Do some research internally on what you and your team would like in a system, and how you feel it would benefit the company if you had the additional resource in place. Then start doing external research to find a product that aligns with your goals and your budget so you can make a strong case to leadership for the addition.

3. Categorize your work

Once you have a trusted system in place and can use technology to provide some more visibility into how you are spending your day, start categorizing your work. How much time is spent on responding to emails? How much time is spent in meetings? How much time do is spent on administrative tasks? How much time is spent on strategizing and big picture items? Once you have a clearer view, you can take ownership of your time and start to identify things that can be cut out or trimmed down. We need to get rid of the notion that meetings are unnecessary. Rather, look at the amount of time you spend in meetings to see what can be combined or communicated online to make better use of your time.

4. Automate non-value add work

Non-value add work (aka work that doesn't contribute to your company's goals) should be automated.

This isn't to say all work will be creatively stimulating 100% of the time. But there are items that can be removed from your day-to-day to relieve some of this administrative burden. Automated work is a higher order of the trusted system, so be sure that process and systems are in place before automating anything. This automation can be as simple as having key rules set up in your email solution that automatically file and store certain emails based upon sender or content, to more sophisticated work management systems that use machine learning to learn the way you are working.

Shadow work isn't always a bad thing. But we need to be mindful of making the right trade-offs and setting clear priorities to bring visibility to our days, and instill an initiative and goal around it. It's important to acknowledge these extra tasks exist and bring it out of the shadows. Only then will we be able to streamline for efficiency and spend more time contributing in a meaningful way.

HOW DO THE ENTERPRISES REDEFINE THEIR AI SOLUTIONS ON THE PUBLIC CLOUD?

By Hans Hsu, Project Solutions Architect, CKmates

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It's a complex process that chooses the right solution among numerous services and integrates them into the enterprise

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The trend of ubiquitous use of Artificial Intelligence was started in 2017 and 2018. The development in two years has led to a close maturity of AI in 2019. Choosing a suitable solution for the business logic of the enterprise out of the numerous AI services provided by the public cloud is undoubtedly a significant topic.

The AI services provided by the major public clouds can classify into three layers:

1. Application Layer

2. Platform Layer

3. Infrastructure Layer

The Application Layer means that the enterprises directly use the out-of-the-box functions provided by the public cloud. Thus, Developers can develop without understanding complex mathematical theories and model concepts. They only use AI functions through API, merely focus on the workflow and business logic of the company instead of cooperating with data scientists and data engineers by a complicated training process.

The Platform Layer refers to the enterprise directly using the development platform provided by the public cloud,

enabling enterprises to customize the unique AI features. For instance, Amazon SageMaker integrates the most common tools used by data scientists or data engineers into a service or SDK, can be united and can be scaled the computing performance horizontally; you can also control the model version and replace the appropriate model. In short, there are services available from data cleaning to training models, but the business logic and ownership of the model lies in the company. At the platform level, companies can focus on AI model development rather than managing infrastructure (e.g., operating system updates, hardware updates, etc.) and the installation of related packages, therefore, companies can develop AI features that better meet the business demands.

The Infrastructure Layer refers to the operation of the enterprise to customize the operating system or adjust the underlying parameters of the operating system. The public cloud also provides directly usable computing resources: Virtual machine (EC2), AWS provides flexible NVIDIA GPU (Elastic Graphics, Amazon Elastic Inference) or AWS's EC2 optimized for AI operations and pre-installed drivers and

prevalent machine learning and deep learning framework, you can enjoy AWS's fast and efficient AI hardware resources directly after the operating system boot.

However, it's a considerably complex process that chooses the right solution among numerous services and integrates them into the enterprise. Ckmates, as an AWS MSP Provider, supports clients with customized solutions for the enterprise, selects appropriate AWS services according to the customer's current technology stack, integrates existing architecture, helps customers set milestones and grows with customers. For example, we assist in combining AI development and DevOps automation processes, AI computing resource configuration in the on-premise data center and the cloud, security of data used by cloud AI and assisting in the protection of public cloud technology. Under the framework provided by the public cloud, through the above-mentioned interactive use of several layers, whether it is a professional IT company or a non-IT professional company can easily select the appropriate AI development solutions from which to enhance the competitiveness of the enterprise.

DEFINING &
SHAPING
THE FUTURE OF

PAYMENTS

The word 'PAYMENTS' is rendered in large, bold, red capital letters. Each letter contains a small, circular inset image. From left to right: the 'P' shows a hand inserting a card into a terminal; the first 'A' shows a woman in a brown jacket at a counter; the 'Y' shows a woman holding a smartphone; the 'M' shows a woman holding a smartphone; the 'E' shows a man using a card reader; the 'N' shows a man using a card reader; and the 'T' shows a man using a card reader.



ICHINEN HOLDINGS



ICHINEN HOLDINGS CO.,LTD.

Eliminating the Complexity of Fleet Management for Businesses



MASASHI KURODA
CEO

“

Ichinen Holdings offers automotive comprehensive fleet management, and contract maintenance. Customers to reduce their business expenses and boost the efficiency of their work

”

The efficient use of vehicles plays an important role in improving the performance of large and small businesses. So, the choices made about financing the vehicles and fleet management can be crucial to a business's success. But the hard reality is, as the fleet grows, the complexity associated with fleet management also grows at breakneck speed and becomes a huge bottleneck. As a result, businesses find it hard to keep a fleet up and running.

Realizing this increased need for efficient fleet management, one company that came to the forefront to reduce the fleet management complexity and ensure the safety of vehicles is Ichinen Holdings Co., Ltd. Founded in 1930, Ichinen Holdings provides the top-notch fleet management and automobile leasing services to its customers.

“It has become common for people to use “maintenance leasing” for automobile leasing in order to reduce vehicle management and ensure safety. We strive to provide our customers with



“ The basic management principle of our company is to reward our shareholders and employees and to be of service to society by fully satisfying a great number of customers. ”

“maintenance leasing” having high added value by way of advanced services that are well-suited to the era of automobile leasing,” says Masashi Kuroda, CEO of Ichinen Holdings.

Delivering Wide Range of Exemplifying Services

Headquartered in Osaka, Ichinen Holdings offers automotive leasing, fleet management, and contract maintenance as well as fuel sales services in Japan. It has a fleet of more than 61,000 leased vehicles with a similar number on fleet management. Its automobile leasing services reduce the administrative tasks for automotive maintenance which makes it possible for its clients to use automobiles safely with peace of mind. The company performs periodic, preventive maintenance on the vehicles used by its clients and also offers uniform gasoline prices all across Japan.

“What’s more, we set a uniform price all across Japan for the sale of fuel by way of the economy of scale that only ICHINEN is capable of,” asserts Masashi.

In addition to fleet management, the company also delivers services in various sectors including chemicals, parking, sales of machine tools, and synthetic resins with thought given to people, corporations, society, and the environment. Ichinen Holdings Co., Ltd is the holding company of Ichinen Group which develops these businesses and further improves the added value of its products by way of powerful synergies. As a whole, it provides total support for the corporate management of its customers.

Built On the Core Principle of Customer Centricity

Apart from its superior services another reason that makes the firm stand out in the industry is its customer-centric approach. It not just focuses on providing all-around services but also emphasizes on further improving its services for its customers.

“The basic management principle of our company is to reward our shareholders and employees and to be of service to society by fully satisfying a great number of customers with our excellent quality and services and by securing a reasonable profit,” states Masashi.

Aims To Strengthen and Expand Its Services

Moving forward, the company endeavours to strengthen the business foundation of the group that is aimed at the next generation. Meanwhile, it also plans to continue strengthening its existing businesses. The company is confident to be a revolutionary factor in the industry over the coming years with its innovative services and strong determination.

Just as its slogan says, Ichinen strives to provide its customers with amenities through its businesses to ensure that each and every day is the best one for its customers.

“Furthermore, we will provide our customers with a wide range of amenities that are not bounded by our business areas and we will aim to expand our businesses so as to better contribute to society throughout the world,” concludes Masashi.

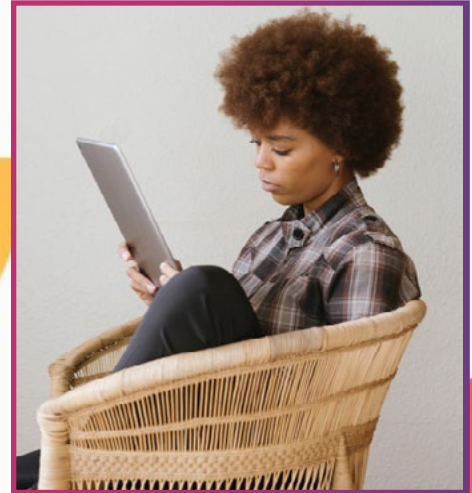
MINIMIZING WORKPLACE DISTRACTION AND IMPROVING PRODUCTIVITY

By Ruth Young, Staff Writer

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Distraction in the workplace is costing companies billions of dollars in lost opportunity and productivity

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So, how was your weekend?” begins the early morning welcome conversation. It might feel like a good start for the day but time flies and, 10 minutes later, you realize you have to submit an important project today. You turn on your computer with a fresh cup of coffee in hand and begin scrolling through emails, while simultaneously running through a mental checklist of things to get done for the day. You then go through the mails and check out a few notifications and when you glance at the clock, almost an hour has gone by and you haven’t even started yet. Does this sound familiar?

The truth is we all face distractions at work every single day, and typically every single hour. Even when we’re ‘snowed under’ with work, we still check our emails, scroll through Insta stories, or surf the internet for cheap vacation flights. But have you

ever wondered exactly how much these distractions cost your company’s bottom line? Billions of dollars, yes, you heard it right. Distraction in the workplace is costing companies billions of dollars in lost opportunity and productivity. So, how to keep the distraction at bay and get a grip on productivity? To answer that, we’ve come up with some simple yet effective ways to curtail distractions.

Limit the Digital Distraction

We are living in an age of distractions where apps, gadgets, and social media are constantly vying for our attention. According to McKinsey, employees fritter 28 of their working hours in checking and replying to their mail. Meanwhile research by The Economist reveals that using social media at work costs the US economy 650 billion dollars—\$4500 per worker

each year. It’s mind-boggling, isn’t it? These figures are hard to sink in. But the truth is digital distraction siphon off a lot more time and money than we think.

So what’s the fix? Instead of reacting to something the moment it comes up, finish the task at hand first. Whether it’s your buzzing phone, email notification on your screen, or a question from a colleague if it’s going to take more than 2 minutes, add it to your to-do list and do it later. To avoid the urge to check your phone each time, try turning off notifications.

Cut Out the Unproductive Meetings

Sitting with a group of people in the conference room with no clue what’s going on in the meeting while making holiday plans or grocery list for the month in mind—

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most of us can relate to this. Nearly everyone who works in an office has experienced the pain of attending a meeting that has nothing to do with them at all. This is because some companies feel that having every member in the meeting is 'inclusive'.

But the reality is that meetings can be the biggest time sucker or productivity killer if employees won't learn anything valuable out of it or won't contribute in a meaningful way. An average worker attends around 62 meetings a month, but 91 percent of them feel guilty of day-dreaming, while 39 percent admit that they fall asleep. So, instead of investing time in such unproductive meetings, employers should focus more on involving employees in some productive work.

Sidestep Chatty Co-workers

"Got a minute?" is the most common question we heard from our co-worker while working on a task. But it's never just a minute, is it? Even if the interruption is short the impact is not. Indeed, research shows that it takes an average of almost 25 minutes to resume the task at hand after an interruption. So while it might take just a second to snap out of it, getting back to what you were doing is not that simple. Many employees admit they lose up to 5 hours a day due to distraction. And it's not just time they're giving up but also focus and concentration along with their productivity and performance.

A new poll by Udemy and Toluna revealed that 80 percent of people report being distracted by chatty coworkers, the leading culprits for lack of workplace productivity. We all have to deal with that one co-worker who is loud, noisy and constantly distracting. Conversation is crucial for building a friendly, collaborative culture within the office, but spending too much time in conversation can hamper your productivity. To avoid such distraction you could politely explain that you're running against a dead-

line and you'll catch up with them later. Failing that, you can switch off the distraction by plugging in noise-canceling headphones.

Don't Fall Into Multitasking Trap

You take calls while working on spreadsheets. You surreptitiously order lunch while attending an important staff meeting. Switching from task to task, you think you are being more productive. But you're actually not. You are not putting forth your best effort when your attention is divided. In fact, when you multitask you are prone to making more mistakes and potentially damaging your brain. So, it's better to focus on one task at a time instead of juggling with multiple tasks.

Escape Internal Distractions

While it might be a bit easier to tackle all the external workplace interruptions but one source of distraction that is pretty tough for even the most focused worker to ignore is the 'noise' inside their heads. You working on a report and you heard or see the word 'key' and it reminds you that you need to take your car key and repair your car and get gas on your way home. Then, you start to think about what else you need to do and before you know it you completely forget what you were focusing on just a few minutes ago. Whether it's the list of errands you need to do or the feeling of guilt about something you said earlier in the day, it keeps revolving in our mind and hinder our productivity. The best way to eliminate such distraction is to take breaks in between and allocating some time for such distraction so that such thoughts won't cross your mind during work-hour.

Take Short Breaks

Do you feel proud that lunch break is the only break you take in a whole day? Do you think that you are achieving optimal productivity by allocating the rest of your attention on work? Well, sorry to disappoint you but according to researchers at

the University of Illinois, it can actually hamper concentration over time. Remember, staying back late at work and working continuously doesn't exactly reflect more productivity. In fact it points out your poor time management skills.

Believe it or not, taking small breaks throughout the day is what sustains your focus. When you feel overwhelmed or stuck with an issue, go for a walk to breathe in the fresh air and clear your head and when you will come back, you will see the current task with a fresh lens. You can even follow several productivity techniques such as the Pomodoro technique, where you work for 25 minutes and then rest for 5 minutes to boost your focus and productivity the most.

Stick to strict deadlines

When you have a sword of deadline hanging over you, even the loudest noise will turn into the faintest whisper. The urgency of the moment will make you too focused that you will hardly notice the distractions around you. You have to be in the moment with no time to fritter away and no reason to drag your feet. So, setting a self-imposed deadline and strictly following it can go a long way to minimize the distraction and improving productivity.

The Bottom Line

In a world driven by distraction, staying productive in the workplace is not easy. But you've got two choices — either take control of these distractions or let them control you. If you fail to control the interruptions, it will undermine your performance, increase your stress, and weaken your productivity. However, this doesn't mean you have to work restlessly every now and then to stay productive. Of course, you can have a slack-off day sometimes. But if your unproductive moments occur more and more often, it's time to do a little soul-searching and planning to make distractions go away.

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Jason Puxty, a leading mortgage broker, notes that ezidox™ has singularly delivered a 75% uplift in productivity. With the implementation of ezidox™, the business has been able to reduce the time spent on this task from eight hours to two hours a day.



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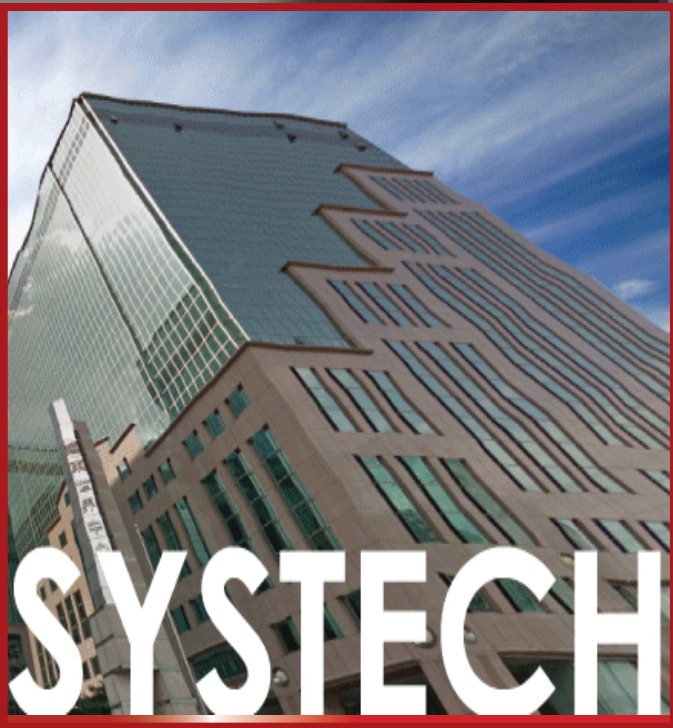
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SYSTECH



A Versatile Solution Provider In Fleet Management With Proven Credibility



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SYSTECH enhances fleet management with the intelligent information to reduce costs and increase fleet performance

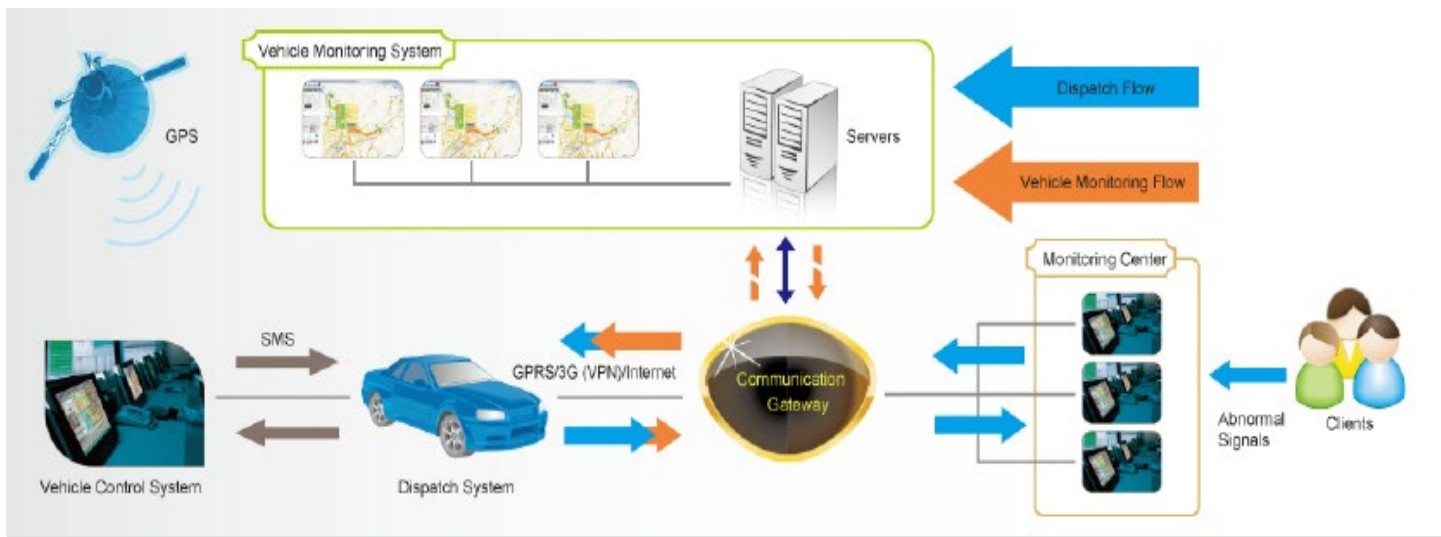
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SYSTECH (Systems & Technology) was started in 1987 in Taiwan with a vision to be to be a global leading provider of fleet management solutions. Today, the company is a market leader with proven solutions specifically in Automatic Vehicle Locating (AVL) and Geographical Information Systems (GIS). With exceptional product development and flexible customization abilities, Systems & Technology products are used in over 180 countries for versatile industries.

The company remains customer-centric despite its versatility in technology product, which has been a primary reason why clients like the company. The CEO of the company says, “We insist on providing an outstanding service for our customers to meet their demanding needs. In transforming creative ideas into realities, SYSTECH always stays true to its commitment to product integrity and safety.”

An Impressive run the leader of the field

During the inception, there was not much technology in the field. SYSTECH has always been a leader in terms of developing new solutions and integrating new technology in transport and fleet management. Today the company has a solid set of in-house product including, Cash-in-Transit, Intelligent bus, fleet safety, waste and recycling.



“

We insist on providing an outstanding service for our customers to meet their demanding needs.

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The first big milestone of the company came in 1997 when its Digital Mapping Products was authorized by the Ministry of Interior Affairs. The following year, the company released the first GPS car navigation system, called RoadEZ. The momentum of introducing new solution continues in the following years. In 2003, the company releases its IntelliTrac products. In 2004, SYSTECH developed the GPS/GPRS System based on anti-theft tracking solution “MoBits” for Honda Taiwan in 2004 which was a major accomplishment in the company’s growth journey. The same year the company developed the first software “FleetWeb” for system integration.

By 2005, the company has already have presence in 70 countries selling their own products. During this time the company also successfully launched the navigation software “RoadEasy” and Location Based Services (LBS) over the Internet. Because of the company success and the proven credibility, SYSTECH obtained partnership opportunities with over 20 hardware manufactures. And by 2007 the company has already distributed it product in over 180 countries worldwide.

During the course of their journey, the company has won multiple awards of their excellency in product development with proven credibility. In 2016, SYSTECH’s Intelligent School Bus System wins System Integration Award at the 2016 Taipei Smart City & Summit Expo.

Providing superior quality solution for intelligent life

The company mission statement is to provide superior quality AVL solutions in achieving the intelligent life. This has been very consistent with the kind of product and solutions the company has been putting out. Guided by strong values of committed service to customers through exceptional performance and

accomplishing, the company has always deliver what it promised.

The core focus of the company includes innovation, proficiency, flexibility, quality, reliability, and service.

Innovation: Design innovative solutions for all fleet management needs.

Proficiency: Experts are trained for the most demanding markets.

Flexible customization ability: Sophisticated customization ability to fulfill customers’ a variety of requirements.

Efficiency: Cost-Effective. Increase customers’ profitability.

Quality: Committed to providing customers with our exceptional products and service.

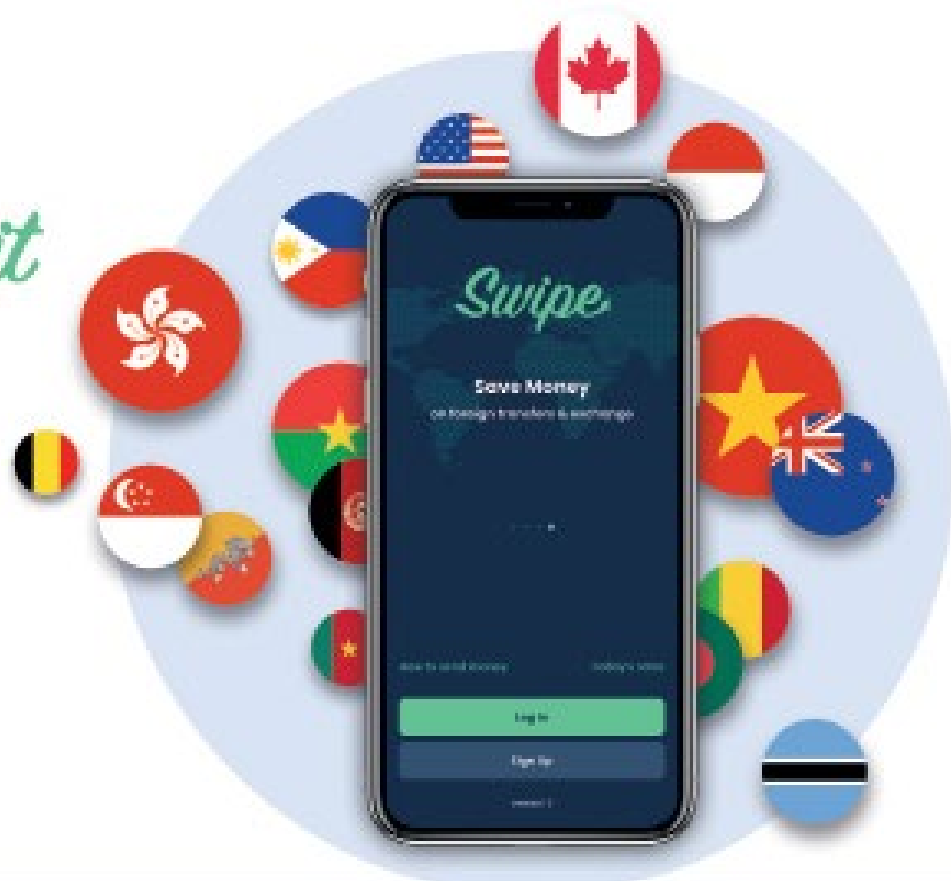
Reliability: Act with integrity and respect and fulfill our promises.

Service: Strive to provide our customers a comprehensive range of services with innovative solutions.

A Partner to be trusted in Fleet Management

From GPS tracking and vehicle diagnostics to asset trackers, you’ll be amazed at everything SYSTECH can do. With industry-leading fleet tracking devices that provide a variety of alerts, reports, and features, SYSTECH enhances fleet management with the intelligent information to reduce costs and increase fleet performance. And the best part about the company is the dedicated service professionals who are always there to help its customers get the most out of the SYSTECH fleet management solutions.

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THE FUTURE OF DIGITAL COUPON

By Dicky Ying, Founder and CEO of Mezzofy

“

When there is a global standard of digital coupons, both merchants and consumers will have more confidence in such global recognized coupons, and the exchange of such coupons around the world will become feasible.

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Let me skip the basic and go to the core of the future development of digital coupon.

On merchant-friendly

In future, those coupon platforms requiring merchants to hire a lot of staff and put in a lot of resources in order to issue their own digital coupons can hardly survive? Why I think so? Because as far as I understand, at least one advanced platform already allows merchants to create, issue and redeem their own digital coupons without any technical support or upfront cost. All the merchants need to do is to download an app from App Store or Google Play, and do everything including creation, distribution and redemption of their own digital coupons with just a mobile phone.

On consumer-friendly

As a consumer, you may find it inconvenient to download any digital coupons because you are often required to download a new app for each and every coupon you wish to

receive. As a consumer, I also find it annoying. In fact, it's a barrier for the development of digital coupon business as a whole. In the future, only those platforms which can overcome this barrier may become popular. At present, most platforms still maintain the barriers. Fortunately, to the extent of my knowledge, at least one coupon platform have already cut the red tape and allowed consumers to receive digital coupons from its platform without downloading any apps. When consumers wish to download any digital coupons from the platform issued by any merchants, all they need to do is to make a click and the coupon will be issued to their registered email boxes or their mobile phones direct by SMS. When one needs to use the digital coupon, he/she just needs to retrieve it from his/her email boxes/SMS boxes and send/ show it to the merchant concerned for redemption direct.

On global standard

In future, digital coupons may have global standard just like barcode.

All merchants of the world use the same barcode standard so that their products made in any places can be sold in any shops around the world without any hiccups. If and when there is a global standard of digital coupons, both merchants and consumers will have more confidence in such global recognized coupons, and the exchange of such coupons around the world will become feasible. Technically speaking, it's possible. And the rest will be decided by the market.



TECHNOLOGY IN HIGHER EDUCATION

By Anne Kealley, CEO, Caudit

“

We will need ubiquitous Wi-Fi along with easy-to-use video conferencing at the desktop, laptop and on mobile devices facilitating a seamless way of learning

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Heraclitus, a Greek philosopher of the late 6th century BCE, said the world is identified by ‘an ongoing process governed by a law of change’. Even if we look at just the last 50 years we can see that change is an essential and natural part of life. It follows then, that to remain relevant, IT in Higher Education must continue to adapt and where possible, lead the way in order to help institutions meet the demands of future students, researchers and administrators.

With funding increasingly focused on successful student progress and completion, along with achievement of competitive research outcomes, it is essential for IT to play its part in determining technology investments to deliver key services, enable

digital capabilities and provide competitive advantage. The ability to deliver effective services in an agile, time-sensitive way is predicated by IT being engaged in conversations at a strategic level with the organization’s leadership, staff and students and aligned to support the institution’s goals.

The push-pull between centralization/decentralization, budget pressures, and provision of reliable infrastructure and the need to be seen to be responsive and delivering value in a timely way have been common themes throughout my 20 years in HE. We need to know, with fair a degree of detail, who our stakeholders are and who is likely to be impacted by the implementation of a new initiative or a breakdown in service

and build relationships with them before they are impacted. Collaboration needs to be our normal way of thinking, operating and making decisions. A good example of this is the implementation of a new ITSM tool in a university with decentralized IT support. By including all of the IT Managers from the faculties and research schools as members of the Project Management Group from the very beginning a successful implementation was achieved. And while some things could have been done differently or better, this phase of the project provided a good foundation for further development and other projects.

The project mentioned above was not ‘cutting edge’ from a technical point of view however it did involve signif-



ificant change for IT in the university. An ITSM tool was introduced for the first time. Use of ITIL was introduced for the first time. The project was done in collaboration with all of the IT Managers. A significant difference to previous projects was the inclusion of all key stakeholders in the project management team and true 'ownership' by the members of the Steering Committee. There were some key messages throughout. For the Project Management Group it was that 'this' has to work for all of us. For the Steering Committee it was that their job was to ensure the project was successful. My personal commitment and leadership was also important.

I would also say that 'Investment Logic Mapping' (Developed by the Department of Treasury & Finance in Victoria, Australia⁰) is a really valuable tool for getting to the crux of why a project should be undertaken and what the benefits should be.

It is important to ask what our organizations goals are. How can technology help and provide competi-

tive advantage? When it comes to the IT operation, what are the things that are core to our operation / that we must do? What are the things that are not core and that others are better placed to do? Where do the things we do add value to our organization? Ask: how does 'this' (e.g. project outcomes) benefit the organization, its staff and its clients?

I believe good governance, good planning processes (with the end user as the focal point), enterprise architecture and good project management can do much to improve the effectiveness of how universities operate. Key to all of this is to utilize the skills, knowledge and enthusiasm of the IT team.

It is important to be true to yourself –to be authentic and to have focus on a clear vision. Emotional intelligence; honesty and ethics, courage; fairness; empathy; confidence and good communication skills are also key.

The changing nature of work, with the shift to 'virtual', 'mobile' and 'flexible', will mean universities

need to look at where and how people are working, learning or studying. We will need ubiquitous Wi-Fi along with easy-to-use video conferencing at the desktop, laptop and on mobile devices facilitating a seamless way of learning and interacting with and between students and colleagues wherever they may be.

Access to work tools, corporate records, working documents and information should be easy regardless of where people are and what device they are using because they are 'in the cloud', not locked away in some difficult to get at file server or, worse still, still in paper format. 'Digital first' will be the mantra. There will be an increasing push to automate and for seamless integration between different functions.

Open access to data and to people with the data carpentry skills to support researchers and analytics to gain competitive advantage / improve student outcomes plus cyber security will gain prominence. Predictive analytics and artificial intelligence will help improve student success.

ONE CAN GET OBSOLETE BEFORE GETTING POPULAR

By Mr. Abel Garamhegyi, PhD, President for APAC, Deputy Chairman of Board ,Cellum

“

Data collection, the ownership of it and the way we utilize the collected data for a good purpose will be the next elements of success in the payment area

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Mobile payment solutions have been on the market for the past 15 years. Whilst some innovative front-runner solution providers were trying to convince customers about the usability and convenience of this payment method and tried to predict the future market, others focused on vendors and how they could draw in customers. Only a minor group of solution providers prioritized security. Individual transaction amounts were small, making this approach idle.

There is now a common understanding that transaction and data security have become the number one priority. Companies that were previously lagging on this front have now diminished. All key players (developers, operators) in the field of alternative payment system are aiming to develop the most easy-to-use

and elaborate products and services while maintaining utmost security. Since this kind of ‘orientation’ period is over, and security in transactions and data storage become a prerequisite, what can companies offer to differentiate themselves?

In Europe and in the US, there are various payment methods available—mobile payment is one of them—making transactions practically instantaneous. Due to the vast number of payment options on the market, it is vital for the more unconventional payment systems to be attractive, simple, fast and reliable for the end-user, affordable and traceable for the merchant, while being profitable for the developer and operator.

It is a challenge indeed. Traditional payment providers have been developing their infrastructure and

ecosystem for years, investing large sums of money whereas with mobile wallets there is a misconception that marketing efforts are unnecessary, considering they are ‘self-selling’ and trendy’ products.

This misconception might be one of the reasons why the big hit has not arrived yet and card payments are still dominating the digital transaction market.

In Asia on the other hand, the majority of the population still doesn’t have a bank account. As cash can be a hassle, not to mention the security risk, e-money quickly penetrated the market and has been on the rise since. Systems, balance handlers, payment engines, and gateways, and mobile applications were rapidly developed, albeit many faced security challenges. Considering that end-users had limited options, they started



Companies in the mobile payments industry had to reinvent the unique selling proposition of their products, even before they had become dominant in the market

using these payment methods intensively, creating a new need scalability.

Most of the technology providers had not experienced such a boom in their products that emerged in Asian countries, which comes as no surprise, as in the past these solutions were useful, 'nice to have' but not a necessity. Companies are now facing technical issues as well as architectural limits in their software.

Responding to the rapidly growing demand and large number of players in the payment space, in countries such as Indonesia has led seeking out new features on the e-money service. Facilitating payment, even the most sophisticated ones are not enough to gain extra market share; mobile applications must offer additional benefits in order to secure daily usage and attain customer retention. Such value adding benefits may be loyalty schemes, coupons,

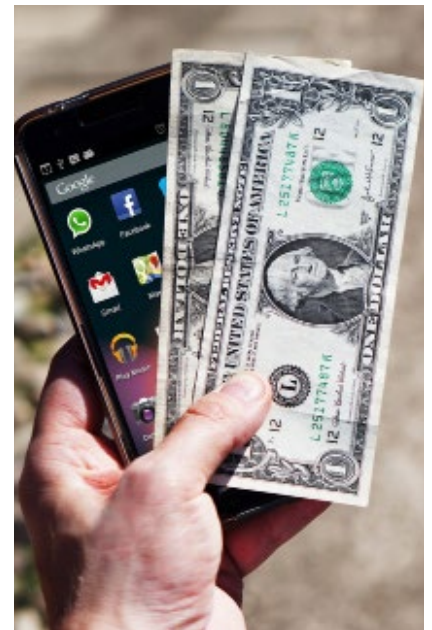
vouchers or gift cards.

These value-added services are driven by data; data about customers, their payment behavior and patterns, when and how they redeem coupons and vouchers, where, when and how they collect and spend their loyalty points, etc.

As Ms. Ginny Rometty, CEO of IBM, stated in 2013: "I want you to think about data as the next natural resource for the next century." The importance of data is continuously and rapidly increasing. Data collection, the ownership of it and the way we utilize the collected data for a good purpose will be the next elements of success in the payment area, especially when it comes to mobile payment.

In a nutshell, companies in the mobile payments industry had to reinvent the unique selling proposition of their products, even before they

had become dominant in the market. Continuous innovation is especially important and more vital now than ever before. The key to success is an agile and flexible approach and it is also where the real opportunity lies for small and medium players.



A ROLE IN THE WORKPLACE

By Prof. Pierre Brunswick, CEO, NeuroMem

“ I truly believe that nonstop learning, and pattern recognition offered by Neuromorphic technology can become practical and ubiquitous only if it can rely on components inspired by the human brain (Neuromorphic memories). ”



Al's role in the workplace is just starting and there is a long journey ahead of us. Today, there are still very few businesses investing in developing AI-based solutions. When they do, the focus seems to be on one aspect of AI—deep learning, an idea using the Perceptron classifier that was originally introduced in the 1980s but had to be abandoned due to lack of computing technology and lack of big data and the cloud, now enjoying a resurgence.

On the other hand, cognitive systems based on neuromorphic technology, which has also been around since late 1980s developed by companies like General Vision, are probably a better engine for businesses because they consume low power and offer non-stop learning. This also means that because it focuses on anomalies at the source, it uses less resources including data, cloud and internet, creating a lower cost

of operations and is much faster.

I truly believe that nonstop learning, and pattern recognition offered by neuromorphic technology can become practical and ubiquitous only if it can rely on components inspired by the human brain (neuromorphic memories), merging storage and local processing per cell, with massively parallel interconnected cells operating at low power. It also vastly reduces the time to market for businesses planning to implement robust AI solutions at a hardware level.

There is a need for more education to empower businesses to adopt AI faster and stay ahead of the competition. Proponents of neuromorphic technology are working with developers of a wide range of applications across the globe. In the hardware-based sector, there is a drive on the integration of AI in smart buildings, smart infrastructure, se-

curity, medical and related applications, automotive sector, drones, IoT and robotics—anywhere that uses sensors to filter information to make business decision, securely and cost effectively.

Neuromorphic technology also excels at commonly-used iris and face recognition. The neurons detect faces without having to identify them as an individual, which cuts down on the need for personal information in its functioning. Using parallel architecture allows the massive scalability of the product makes it usable in crowded areas like metros and airports.

If businesses want to stay competitive, they need to start investing in tools and collaborate with organizations that can help them develop Proof of Concept (POC) solutions based on their customized needs. There is no one size fits all solution when it comes to AI.



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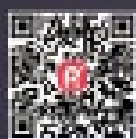
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